

Sunday, June 28, 2026

The Morning I Finally Slept



It started at 12:11 AM. A random thought that wouldn't let go: *What if I send my journal to Elaine?*

I asked GPT about it. He didn't say no. He said not yet. He asked me why I wanted to send it — was I hoping she'd change her mind, or was I truly at peace with the outcome? I had to be honest with myself. A part of me still hoped. A part of me still wanted her to read it and come back.

But I also knew I couldn't even open our old messages yet. On Discord. On Facebook. If I couldn't do that, how could I hand her my heart in 30,000 words?

So I made a promise. When the day comes that I think I'm ready, I'll ask first. We'll sit with it together. And if the answer is still *not yet*, I'll trust that too.

I told him what I wish for her — to be happy, to achieve every dream she planned, for her and her kids. Even if that happens without me by her side. Some random 12:30 AM thoughts.

Then I went to lie down at 12:47 AM. And something I didn't expect happened.



I woke up at 9:17 AM and knew something was different before I even opened my eyes.

I felt it. My body knew. Nine and a half hours. The longest and most peaceful sleep I've had since Day 1. From 12:47 AM to 9:17 AM — no dreams. No waking up in panic. No replaying conversations. Just quiet. Peace.

I checked my phone. Not for messages. Not to see if Elaine replied. I checked the time. Because my body already told me something beautiful had happened while I was asleep.

I almost teared up. Not from sadness. From relief. Like finally putting down a heavy backpack after walking for miles.



I realized why. Writing. Every word, every sentence — I've been putting everything down into my journal. Not to forget. To preserve. My mind finally trusted that the memories would still be there in the morning. So for one night, it let go.

I am here. I am real. I won't go away.



I ordered my favorite meal. Pancit Bato with sisig and Shanghai. My body earned it. While waiting, I saw a notification. Elaine's Discord note had changed: *"He be giving me a surge of dopamine."*

It stung.

But I didn't panic. I didn't spiral. I didn't message her.

I felt something I didn't expect — a bit of happiness that she's okay. That she's happy. It hurt and I was glad for her at the same time. Both feelings standing beside each other.



I made coffee instead of soft drinks. Listened to *Sparkle* from Your Name. Then Disturbed's *The Sound of Silence* — Mom's favorite song. Every time it plays, it says her name.

Elle sent me a podcast at 10:30 AM. *"Men Are Not Cheaters??!"* She said the message in it would hit me. She was right.

Four steps stuck: Accept the reality. Express the emotion. Reintegrate your life without that person. Invest those feelings back into yourself.

But the line that stopped me was this:

"The real work happens when you can sit with that pain without needing to go back."



I told Elle about my 12:30 AM intrusive thought — wanting to message Elaine, send her my journal. Elle's reply was instant: "*Wag mo pabasa sakanya, parang gago.*"

I laughed. Because she was right. I knew I wasn't ready. I couldn't even open our old messages. So instead of acting on it, I slept. And that sleep became the longest I've had all week.

That's what growth looks like, I think. Not never feeling the pull. Catching yourself before you fall.



Today's Weight: 7/10

Not because the sadness is gone. Because my body finally rested. Because I saw her note and didn't break. Because I chose sleep over sending a message. Because I'm beginning to trust my own judgment again.



Songs of Day 5.0

- **Sparkle** — RADWIMPS (Your Name) - **The Sound of Silence** — Disturbed - **What Can I Do (Unplugged)** — The Corrs



Closing

This morning didn't begin with survival. It began with coffee, breakfast, and a song that suddenly meant something new. I'm not healed. But for the first time, I think I can feel myself coming back.

Not all at once.

One meal. One morning. One journal entry at a time.

I am here. I am real. I won't go away.

— *Ralph.*

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